

Students should have an understanding of:

4.1	Buddhist teaching on human rights: Buddhist teachings and responses to the nature and purpose of human rights; why Buddhists might support human rights as important, including reference to upekkha and the Declaration of the International Network of Engaged Buddhists: Towards A Buddhist Culture of Non-Violence and Human Rights (May 1998); divergent Buddhist responses to the need for and application of individual human rights, including the support offered by situation ethics; the problems human rights might cause for Buddhists; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) arguments about human rights and Buddhist responses to them.
4.2	Buddhist attitudes towards equality: Buddhist teachings and responses to the causes of inequality and problems caused by inequality in the world; divergent Buddhist teachings about and practices that reflect equality, including reference to Lotus Sutra 12; possible Buddhist solutions to inequality and why Buddhists may support them.
4.3	Buddhist attitudes towards religious freedom: different Buddhist teachings and responses to the nature and importance of religious freedom, including <i>Towards The True Kinship Of Faiths: How the World's Religions Can Come Together</i> Chapter 9 by the XIV Dalai Lama; the divergent responses of Buddhists to a multi-faith society; the benefits and challenges for Buddhists living in a multi-faith society; Buddhist responses to non-religious arguments (including atheist and Humanist) against aspects of religious freedom.
4.4	Buddhist attitudes to prejudice and discrimination: Buddhist teachings and responses to the nature of prejudice and discrimination, and the problems they cause, including links to situation ethics; Buddhist teachings on why prejudice and discrimination against religions is wrong, including Nipata Sutta.
4.5	Buddhist teachings about racial harmony; different reasons and ways Buddhists have worked for racial harmony, including Vaca Sutta and how these may link to situation ethics; the benefits for Buddhists of living in a multi-ethnic society.
4.6	Buddhist attitudes towards racial discrimination: Buddhist teachings about why it causes problems in society, including Dhammapada 129–140; Buddhist responses to racial discrimination as shown in the life and teachings of the XIV Dalai Lama.
4.7	Buddhist attitudes to social justice: divergent Buddhist responses to and teachings about the nature of the distribution of wealth and opportunity in the UK and the world; Buddhist teaching about social justice, including Sikshasamuccaya 280–281; the different ways Buddhists work for social justice; links to situation ethics.
4.8	Buddhist attitudes towards wealth and poverty: divergent Buddhist teachings and responses to the nature and causes of poverty in the UK and in the world; Buddhist teachings about wealth and poverty, including Cula Kammavibhanga Sutta, gaining merit and dana, and how these may link to situation ethics.

This area of study comprises a study in depth of Hinduism as a lived religion within the United Kingdom and throughout the world, and its beliefs and teachings on life specifically, about Philosophy of Religion and issues of equality and social justice.

There are four sections: Hindu Beliefs, Philosophy of Religion, Living the Hindu Life and Equality.

The significance and importance of the various beliefs, issues and practices to Hindus today should be explored throughout the sections. This should include reference to how scripture informs a Hindu's understanding of the topics and how approaches to the issues are underpinned by philosophical arguments and ethical theory as applicable.

Students will be expected to study Hinduism within the context of the wider British society, the religious traditions of which are, in the main, Christian. Students should compare and contrast the areas of belief and practice within Hinduism with Christianity as outlined in the content below.

- Beliefs about the afterlife and their significance (1.5)*
- The practice and significance of worship (3.4)*

Students should recognise that Hinduism is one of the many religions and world views in Great Britain, which include Buddhism, Judaism, Islam, Sikhism and non-religious views such as Humanism and atheism. This knowledge may be applied throughout the assessment of the specified content.

Students should compare and contrast the areas of ethics and/or philosophy within Hinduism and non-religious views as outlined in the content below.

Students should also recognise that within Hinduism there may be more than one perspective in the way beliefs and teachings are understood and expressed. Common and divergent views within Hinduism in the way beliefs and teachings are understood and expressed should be included throughout, including reference to Shaivism and Vaishnavism.